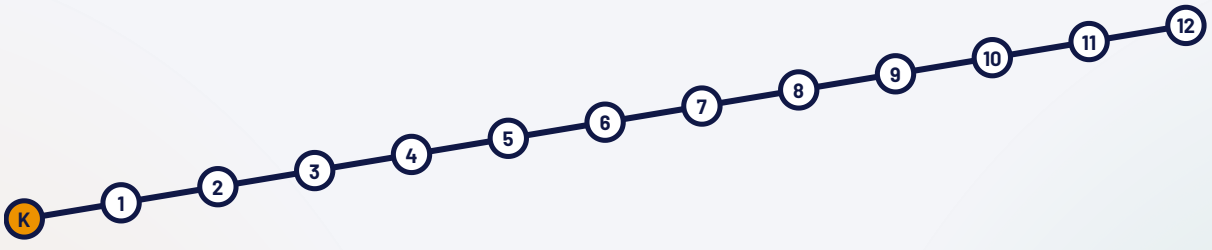
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: Social Studies

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12, with questions and options for our part in the story.



These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade (2,709 ratings, completed November 2026), not what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

Contents

1	**Social Studies, K-12** Social Studies from Kindergarten to Grade 12.	3
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, and the limits.	15

Each part follows the same path: the picture (charts), what the numbers say, what we notice, questions for us, and our part in the story (options for improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). The data behind each item is shown in brackets, and each item links to the matching page of the Vertical Alignment site. About the data (where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use and the limits) is at the back. 18 pages, A4. The bookmarks jump to each part.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

SOCIAL STUDIES, KINDERGARTEN TO GRADE 12

Social Studies, K-12

Across K-12, teachers reported that 40% of the 395 Social Studies ratings (225 standards) are at least introduced, and 4% are taught in depth. It is the subject where a few shared choices could make the biggest difference, and it has clear starting points: Kindergarten (40% in depth) and an Economics thread in Grades 6 and 11.

4%
taught in depth

40%
at least introduced

60%
not taught

395
grade-level ratings

What you are seeing. Four headline figures for this part: the share taught in depth, at least introduced and not taught, and how many ratings they come from.

What it adds to our story. This is the starting picture for this part. The slides that follow show where these numbers come from and what they might mean for us.

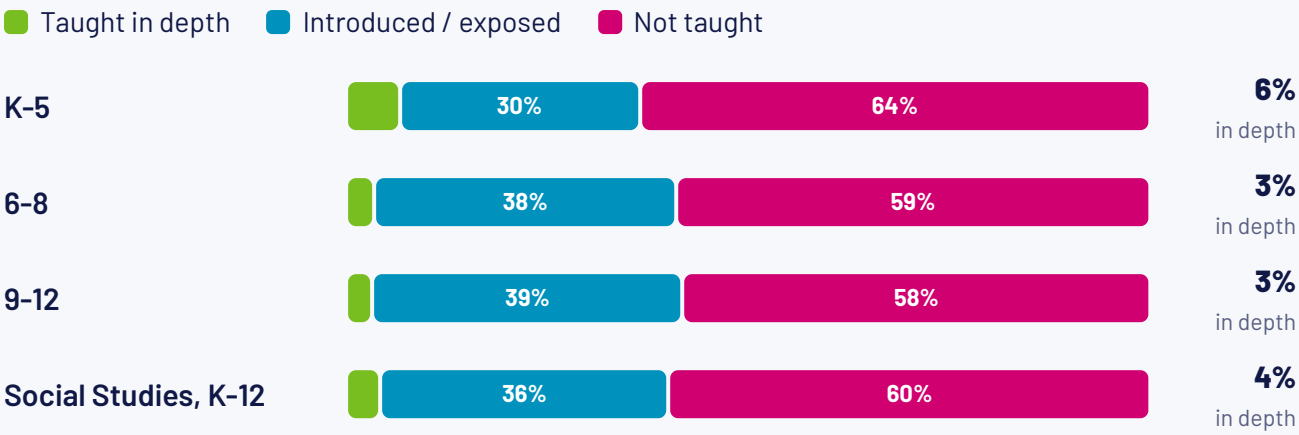
These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

THE PICTURE

At a glance

What you are seeing. Each bar shows all the ratings for one subject: green is taught in depth, blue is introduced, pink is not taught.

What it adds to our story. Social Studies is mostly introduced. This is where a few shared choices could make the biggest difference.



How to read this: each bar is 100% of the grade-level ratings. Green is taught in depth, blue is introduced or exposed, pink is not taught. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

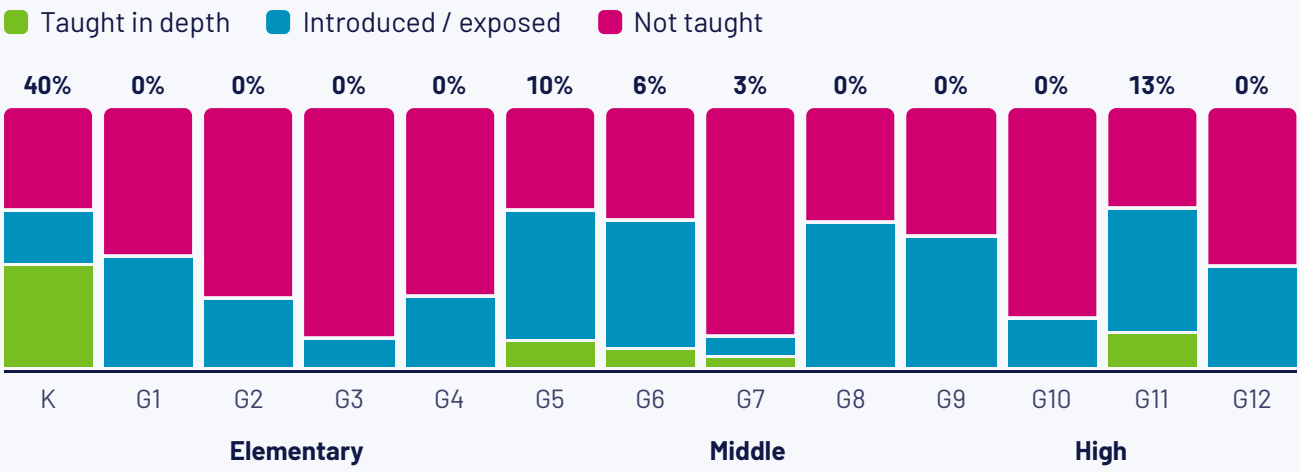
	Rated	In depth	Introduced	Not taught
K-5 (AERO Social Studies)	**97**	**6%**	**30%**	**64%**
6-8 (Wisconsin)	**192**	**3%**	**38%**	**59%**
9-12 (Wisconsin)	**106**	**3%**	**39%**	**58%**
K-12	**395**	**4%**	**36%**	**60%**

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column for each grade. The number on top is the share of that grade's standards taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. Kindergarten starts strongly. After that Social Studies is mostly introduced, perhaps because much of the time goes to literacy.



How to read this: one column per grade. The number on top is the share taught in depth.

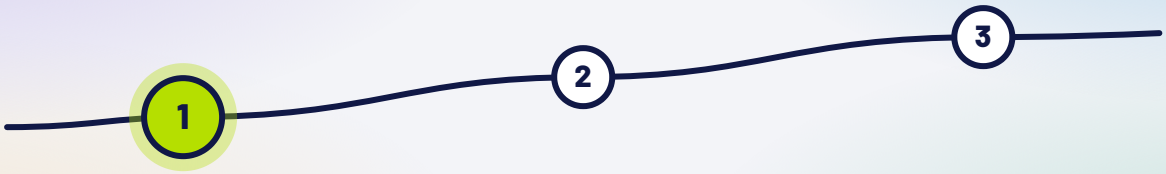
Strand	K	G1	G2	G3	G4	G5	G6	G7	G8	G9	G10	G11	G12
Time, Continuity, and Change	100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Connections and Conflict	100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	100%							
Culture	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Society and Identity	67%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Government	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Production, Distribution, and Consumption	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Science, Technology, and Society	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Geography		0%	0%	0%	0%	25%							
Behavioral Sciences							17%	0%	0%				0%
Economics							23%	0%	0%			23%	
Geography							0%	17%	0%	0%			
History							0%	0%	0%		0%		0%
Inquiry Practices and Processes							0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Political Science							0%	0%	0%				0%

How to read this: each square is the share of that strand's rated standards taught in depth in that grade. Darker green means more in depth. A blank square means the grade has no standards in that strand.

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

SOCIAL STUDIES · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

Section 1: Facts



SECTION 1 OF 3

Facts

What you are seeing. The main facts from the ratings, in plain numbers. Each one links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

What it adds to our story. Many topics are at least introduced across the school, and Economics shows what a thread taught to depth can look like.

Bright spots

Where teaching is strongest.

1. **Economics holds 6 of the 15 in-depth ratings.** Grade 6 has 3 and Grade 11 has 3. Coverage map ↗
2. **Kindergarten is the high point.** Four of its 10 standards are in depth, in identity, time and connections. Kindergarten dashboard ↗

Gaps

Standards rated not taught by the grade they belong to, or where they were placed.

3. **The 5 highest shares not taught.** Grade 7 (91%), Grade 3 (89%), Grade 10 (82%), Grade 2 (74%) and Grade 4 (73%). Coverage map ↗
4. **K-5 strands with no standard rated in depth.** Government, Culture, Production and Consumption, and Science, Technology and Society. Coverage map ↗
5. **Secondary strands with no standard rated in depth.** Inquiry Practices (70 ratings), History (60) and Political Science (44). Coverage map ↗
6. **Progressions.** 21 of 64 break down: 15 break at a K-5 grade (mostly Grade 2 or Grade 3) and 6 in Grades 6 to 12. Looking at K-5 on its own, 11 of 34 K-5 progressions break down. None is yet taught at every step. Progressions ↗

7. **Standards not taught in any grade they belong to.** 59 confirmed (K-5 38, 6-8 18, 9-12 3). A further 46 are not taught where placed. Gaps and repetition ↗

Breadth without depth

Standards introduced widely but rarely taken to depth.

8. **Five grades introduce about half their standards.** Grade 5 (50%), Grade 6 (50%), Grade 8 (56%), Grade 9 (50%) and Grade 11 (48%). Coverage map ↗
9. **Introduced, never in depth.** 105 standards are introduced and never in depth: 29 in K-5, 40 in 6-8, 36 in 9-12. Gaps and repetition ↗
10. **Shared standards.** Each middle school grade rated the same 64 standards. 86 Social Studies standards were rated by 2 or more grades, and 80 of those are in depth in none. Coverage map ↗

Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

11. **Depth by grade.** K 40%, G1 to G4 0%, G5 10%, G6 6%, G7 3%, G8 0%, G9 0%, G10 0%, G11 13%, G12 0%. Coverage map ↗
12. **Coverage is steady at about 4 in 10.** At least introduced: 36% in K-5, 41% in 6-8, 42% in 9-12. Coverage map ↗
13. **Fifteen ratings in depth, K-12 (of 395).** Kindergarten has 4, Grade 5 has 2, Grade 6 has 4, Grade 7 has 2, Grade 11 has 3. Coverage map ↗
14. **Priority and power standards.** 5% in depth and 55% not taught, across 183 ratings. In Grade 7, 94% of priority standards are not taught. Priority and power (Audit) ↗
15. **Essential Elements (Grades 6 to 12).** 10% in depth, and 22% in high school against 3% for the main standards. Coverage map ↗



SECTION 2 OF 3

Patterns

What you are seeing. What we notice when we put the facts side by side: rises, dips and comparisons. These are possibilities to talk about, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. Social Studies may be where much of our literacy happens, so planning the two together could help both.

Trends across the grades

How things rise, fall or alternate from grade to grade.

1. **Social Studies is consistent across the whole school.** Unlike the other subjects, it does not rise or dip by band: 6%, 3%, 3% in depth, with about 40% of ratings at least introduced in every band. This looks like a whole-school pattern, not the story of any one team. Coverage map ↗

2. **Social Studies starts well in Kindergarten.** Kindergarten's 40% is one of that grade's strongest results, close to Science (46%). Grades 1 to 4 rated none of their standards in depth. The question is what changes after Kindergarten. Coverage map ↗

Handoffs

What passes between grades and between schools.

3. **Economics shows what a thread can look like.** In depth in Grade 6, again in Grade 11, with K-5 standards on needs and wants linked to it. It is also where 5 of the 7 hand-over gaps sit: 3 Grade 6 Economics standards build on K-5 standards rated not taught, and 2 Grade 11 standards build on Grade 6. Progressions ↗

4. **Two standard sets meet at Grade 6.** K-5 uses AERO and Grades 6 to 12 use Wisconsin. The hand-over between them has not been mapped by teachers, only suggested by matching wording. Progressions ↗

Language and literacy

Where language and literacy are taught, and how.

5. **Social Studies inquiry skills are close to what ELA already teaches well.** Research, evidence and argument are in depth in secondary ELA. Social Studies inquiry may be nearer than the ratings suggest, if the two subjects planned together. Coverage map ↗

6. **Social Studies may be where much literacy happens.** Units on families, communities and Qatar carry a lot of vocabulary, speaking and non-fiction reading. Teams may rate this time as literacy rather than Social Studies, which could be part of why Social Studies depth looks low. Coverage map ↗

Essential Elements

Where much teaching may happen at the level students are at.

7. **Essential Elements again run ahead in high school.** In Grade 10, 5 of 9 Essential Elements are in depth while the team rated none of its main standards in depth. Deep teaching may be happening at that level. Grade 10 dashboard ↗

How we rated

Where the ratings may reflect how the scale was read.

8. **Grade 7 rated most standards not taught.** Grades 6 and 8 introduce about half of the 64 standards; Grade 7 rates 91% not taught. This may be about scheduling or course focus that year. Coverage map ↗

Choices and capacity

What a grade can carry in a year, and what we choose.

9. **Time may be the simplest explanation.** With language and reading as the first job in every band, Social Studies may be taught through topics and vocabulary. That fits "introduced" as the usual rating. Coverage map ↗

10. **The subject is introduced, rarely deepened.** Where Social Studies is taught, it is rated "introduced" about 9 times for every 1 time it is rated "in depth" (142 against 15). Topics are met; review and assessment across all classes may be what is missing for "in depth". Coverage map ↗

11. **Our Social Studies priority lists and our teaching do not yet match.** More than half of priority and power ratings are "not taught" (55%). In every other subject that figure is 18% to 20%. The lists may not match what courses teach, or they may be aspirations. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

12. **Few shared standards are taken to depth in any grade.** Middle school standards belong to all three grades, and high school standards span several courses. When a standard belongs to everyone, each grade may leave it to another: 80 of 86 shared standards reach depth nowhere. Coverage map ↗

13. **High school looks organised by course.** Grade 9 Geography (92% introduced), Grade 11 Economics (23% in depth), Grade 12 History (58% introduced). Standards outside each year's course show as not taught. Coverage map ↗

14. **Capacity shows what a grade carries in Social Studies each year.** A grade takes about 1 Social Studies standard to depth a year, introduces about 11 and does not teach about 18, out of about 30 rated. In K-5 it is about 1 of 16, in middle school 2 of 64, in high school 1 of 27. As shares of Social Studies standards: K-5 6% in depth, 30% introduced, 64% not taught; 6-8 3% in depth, 38% introduced, 59% not taught; 9-12 3% in depth, 39% introduced, 58% not taught. Capacity here means what a grade currently reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. It is not a target and not a judgement. Coverage map ↗

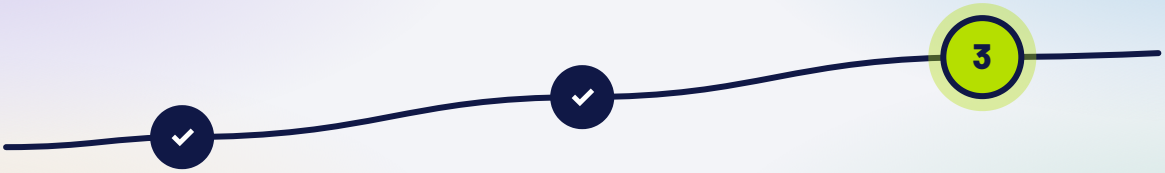
Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

15. **Inquiry is the common thread not yet taught in depth.** Asking questions, using sources, making claims and communicating conclusions run through every grade from 6 to 12. None is in depth, and Grades 9 and 10 rate all 10 of their Inquiry standards not taught. Coverage map ↗

SOCIAL STUDIES · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

Section 3: Moving forward



Facts

Patterns

Moving forward
YOU ARE HERE

SECTION 3 OF 3

Moving forward

What you are seeing. Questions for teams to talk about. Each one shows the data that prompted it, and links to where that figure appears on this page.

What it adds to our story. These questions are about choosing a few Social Studies standards per grade to take deeper, often through literacy we already teach.

Improving the curriculum

What to teach, deepen, place or leave out.

1 **How can we embed Social Studies standards more deeply into the reading, writing and discussion we already teach?**

(Data: Social Studies is 4% in depth K-12; ELA is 35%, and over 50% in secondary) see Fact 8

Coverage map ↗

2 How do Qatar History and our Social Studies standards relate, and are students meeting some standards there?

(Data: History is 0% in depth across 60 secondary ratings) see Fact 11

Coverage map ↗

3 If we could add depth to one Social Studies strand next year, which would matter most to our students?

(Data: Economics is the only strand in depth in both middle and high school (Grades 6 and 11), with 6 of the 15 in-depth ratings) see Fact 1

Coverage map ↗

4 Could Social Studies inquiry and ELA research be planned as one sequence from Grade 6 to Grade 12?

(Data: 0 of 70 Inquiry ratings in depth; Grades 9 and 10 rate all 10 Inquiry standards not taught) see Fact 2

Coverage map ↗

5 On the site, do the high school standards sit in the courses that teach them?

(Data: 22 high school standards are not taught where placed; Grade 9 Geography is 92% introduced while other strands that year are not taught) see Pattern 13

Gaps and repetition ↗

6 If each grade chose 3 to 5 Social Studies standards to take to depth, which would they be?

(Data: Per grade: about 1 in depth, 11 introduced, 18 not taught, out of 30; middle school rates 64 per grade) see Fact 6

Coverage map ↗

7 Which 5 to 8 Social Studies standards per grade matter most for our students in Qatar, and would we commit to taking those to depth?

(Data: 15 of 395 ratings are in depth; each middle school grade rates 64 standards) see Fact 6

Coverage map ↗

8 Which Social Studies units already carry our vocabulary, speaking and non-fiction reading, and could they be planned to take a Social Studies standard to depth at the same time?

(Data: Social Studies is 4% in depth; 142 of its ratings are introduced) see Pattern 10

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels Grades and teams comparing and planning together.

9 What does Kindergarten do in Social Studies that could continue into Grades 1 to 4?

(Data: Kindergarten is 40% in depth; Grades 1 to 4 rated none of their standards in depth) see Fact 11

Coverage map ↗

10 For standards shared across Grades 6 to 8, which grade introduces, which deepens and which assesses?

(Data: 80 of the 86 standards rated by 2 or more grades are in depth in none) see Fact 10

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

What the next grade or school relies on.

11 Where does the AERO K-5 sequence hand over to the Wisconsin Grade 6 standards, and who should map it?

(Data: 5 hand-over gaps run from K-5 into Grades 6 and 7, all on suggested links not yet checked by teachers) see Fact 14

Progressions ↗

How we rate and plan

How we read the scale and plan our time.

12 What would turn a unit that is "introduced" into one that is "in depth": more time, a shared assessment, or agreement across classes?

(Data: 142 ratings introduced against 15 in depth, about 9 to 1) see Pattern 10

Coverage map ↗

13 Do our priority and power lists match what our units and courses teach, and if not, which should change?

(Data: 55% of 183 priority and power ratings are not taught, against 18% to 20% in the other subjects) see Pattern 11

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

14 How is Social Studies scheduled across Grades 6 to 8, and what would the Grade 7 team like us to know?

(Data: Grade 7 rates 91% not taught; Grades 6 and 8 each rate 44% of the same 64 standards not taught) see Pattern 8

Coverage map ↗

15 **With about 1 Social Studies standard in depth per grade, what mix would we choose, and what would we stop doing to make room?**

(Data: Social Studies mix: 4% in depth, 36% introduced, 60% not taught; about 30 standards rated per grade) see Fact 12

Coverage map ↗

Our part in the story

What you are seeing. Options for what we could do, under four headings, each with the data behind it.

What it adds to our story. This is where findings turn into action: small, shared steps we could take together.

Options to discuss and act on. Pick what fits your team, change it, or add your own.

Improving the curriculum

In each grade, we could choose 5 to 8 Social Studies standards to take to depth, and plan them into units we already teach.

(Data: 15 of 395 Social Studies ratings are in depth (4%)) see Fact 1

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels

We might ask Grades 6 to 8 to agree which grade introduces, deepens and assesses each shared standard.

(Data: 80 of 86 shared standards are in depth in none; Grade 7 rates 91% not taught) see Fact 10

Grade 7 dashboard ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

We could plan Social Studies inquiry and ELA research as one sequence from Grade 6 to Grade 12.

(Data: 0 of 70 Inquiry ratings in depth; secondary ELA is over 50% in depth) see Fact 8

Coverage map ↗

A concrete action we could take

We could start with the power and priority lists where most standards are not taught (Grade 7: 17 of 18; Grades 2 and 3: 13 of 15 each), keep the standards that are taught, and replace the rest with ones our units already teach.

(Data: 55% of 183 priority and power ratings are not taught) see Fact 14

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

> **These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers.** They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

Where the numbers come from. Every figure is computed from the ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings, last rating 8 November) and checked against the Vertical Alignment reports and findings decks.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between: some classes, or taught briefly (for example, 3 of 5 classes)

Rating	What it means
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Four things to hold in mind while reading.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught across a whole grade. They are not a measure of what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read that more or less strictly, so a low figure can reflect a stricter reading, not less teaching. Where this matters most, the paper says so. Where a team rated none of its standards in depth, we read it as careful use of an all-or-nothing scale, not as an absence of teaching.
- Each team rated its own subject's standards. Much literacy (vocabulary, academic language, speaking, writing, reading non-fiction) is also taught through Science and Social Studies, and that teaching may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of the main grade-level ratings (one standard in one grade). Essential Elements (the alternate standards) are counted apart.

We cannot teach everything equally. No school can take every standard to depth, and that is not the goal. The goal is to choose on purpose: which standards we teach in depth, which we introduce, and which we leave out, and to plan that proportion together across the grades. The ratings show the mix we have now, so we can decide the mix we want.

Instructional capacity. How many standards a grade reports taking to depth, introducing or leaving out in a year, worked out from the ratings (the average for one grade). It is not a target and not a judgement: it describes the mix we report now, so we can decide together how to use it.

Categories. In every part, each section groups its items under the same categories, in the same order, so a team can follow one kind of observation across the whole school, its band and its subject. Facts: Bright spots, Gaps, Breadth without depth, Anomalies and Other notable. Patterns: Trends across the grades, Handoffs, Language and literacy, Essential Elements, How we rated, Choices and capacity, Toward the SAT and Other notable. Moving forward: Improving the curriculum, Working across grade levels, Knowing the bands above and below, and How we rate and plan. A category with nothing in it is left out.

How each part is laid out. Three sections, each opening with a small map that shows where you are: Facts, then Patterns, then Moving forward (questions to ponder, then options for our part in the story: improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). Every pattern carries its figures in the text, and every question ends with the data behind it, in brackets and italics. The questions are invitations, not conclusions. Our strengths are named alongside the places where we might build.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.
- **Not taught where placed.** The grade it was placed in rated it not taught, and other grades that could teach it were not asked.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.

- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Instructional capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught. They do not measure what students know or can do.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in grades and courses by suggestion. "Not taught" there can mean "taught in another year". 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also not taught in the grade where they were placed.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.